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Digital Literacy Project

VITyarthi E-Learning Platform

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Introduction:

This project was done as part of the Digital Literacy course to help us understand how to use digital tools properly in our academic and daily life. As a Student Digital Ambassador, my role was to create a portfolio that can also help other students learn about digital platforms, online safety, and professional communication.

The project includes five different tasks such as making an infographic, creating online profiles, exploring coding platforms, writing professional emails, and learning about cybercrime. Each task gave practical experience instead of just theory.

Overall, this project helped me become more confident in using digital tools and understand how important it is to behave responsibly online.

Task 1:

Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I used a design tool, Canva, to make a one-page presentation/ infographic which explains what digital literacy is, recommends some useful digital tools for students, and outlines safe internet practices which students should follow. In this day and age, digital literacy is not just a specialized skill, but rather an essential set of knowledge that all people must possess to live a safe and convenient life in this age of technological boom.

The information is given in short points instead of long paragraph to ensure maximum retention and clarity for readers. I used text boxes, icons and shapes of different colours and also added animation to the slide.

What I found most difficult but also later found it interesting after getting an understanding of how the tool works is how the layers work, sometimes I sent things way to back so that none of it was even visible or added images on top of text. I also found interesting how the tool shows you the spatial relationship and measurements of the selected component in relation to other components.

Task 2:

Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, the goal was to set up a foundational portfolio across the key platforms that employers, internship coordinators, and the academic community check. I created accounts on Kaggle and LinkedIn and updated my account on GitHub.

GitHub is a platform that allows developers to host repositories and create, store, manage, and share their code. It provides tools for version control, collaboration, and project management, helping teams work efficiently on projects of any size.
On GitHub I created a profile README and added my educational details in my bio.
I plan to create and maintain a portfolio to showcase my coding skills, collaborate with others on projects to build a strong GitHub profile.

LinkedIn is used for professional networking, career development, job searching, and personal branding.
On LinkedIn, I made an account and filled in the Education section. I plan to use it to build a strong professional network, connect with others, and to stay updated on industry news, trends and opportunities.

Kaggle is a powerful online platform where the data science and machine learning community comes together. It provides a place in which people can work on real-world problems, share knowledge, and participate in competitions. On Kaggle, I created a new account, which I updated with my educational details. I plan to use it to participate in competitions to improve my data science and machine learning skills.

Task 3:

Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For this task, the goal was to explore the right online tools for studying, practising, and collaborating. This task builds familiarity with two categories: coding practice platforms and collaboration tools.

For collaboration tools, I used Google Forms to make a “Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz” containing four MCQ-type questions and one short answer-type question. By taking this quiz, people can test their own knowledge of Digital Literacy. I used the colour feature to make the quiz fit the aesthetic I wanted it to. I set an answer key of my choice, changed the settings to not immediately tell the scores, which automatically edited the settings so that the quiz will record the test-takers’ responses, so that it can be graded. I limited the quiz to take one response per person, and to send the responder their recorded answers by mail if they so choose to.

This is a short quiz, but I understand all the ways which this platform can be used. This has vast number of applications, especially in academic settings. It can be used for quizzes, tests, assignment submissions, registration for events, surveys, taking suggestions, complaints and even as a poll amongst collaborators.

Task 4:

Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist:

❖ **Do's:**

- Think before you post – Make sure your content reflects your values and won't harm your reputation.
- Protect your privacy – Adjust privacy settings and avoid sharing sensitive personal information.
- Be respectful – Communicate politely and consider others' feelings and perspectives.
- Verify information – Check facts before sharing news or claims to avoid spreading misinformation.
- Use social media productively – Follow educational pages, join academic groups, and build your network.

❖ **Don'ts:**

- Overshare personal details — Avoid posting your address, phone number, or financial information.
- Engage in online arguments — Heated debates can escalate quickly and damage your image.
- Post inappropriate content — Offensive or unprofessional posts can affect future opportunities.
- Fall for fake news or scams — Be cautious of suspicious links and offers.
- Neglect real-life responsibilities —Avoid excessive use that interferes with studies or relationships.

This task was focused on learning how to draft a professional email and learning the etiquette guide and Social Media Do's and Don'ts.

The second part of the task is outlined above in a bulleted checklist. These tips, while useful for every person, is especially useful for college or university students in India.

For the first part of the task, I wrote two emails — one to a professor requesting an extension on an assignment submission deadline and the other to an internship coordinator at a company, expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity. Being able to digitally communicate in an appropriate way is an essential skill to have in this day and age.

Say, hypothetically, there are three students in a class who have accidentally been marked as absent, in spite of being present.

The professor has a rule of being contacted only through mail regarding attendance and not in his cabin. One of the students, despite being aware of this rule, was not confident in his abilities to communicate effectively digitally so decided to disregard said rule and meet the professor in his cabin, only earning a tongue-lashing as the professor was not receptive to what he was saying. So, despite being present and honest regarding his complaints, he was not granted his attendance.

The second student mailed him, but was still not granted his attendance though. Why? Because the way he addressed him and wrote the mail was so unprofessional that he made a wrongful image of himself in front of the professor that it was assumed that was a dishonest person. No appropriate greeting, writing in informal language and in an accusatory manner and no proper sign-off.

The third one though, mailed him and mailed him well. He wrote an appropriate subject line and appropriate salutations, addressing him as “Respected Sir”, wrote in formal, professional language, granted thanks and apologized for inconvenience caused and signed off properly, with “Yours sincerely” and with his name, reg no. and class details. And, because he followed the rules and also knew how to communicate properly digitally, he was granted his attendance.

Task 5:

Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide (Prevention Checklist)

This task focused on creating a “Stay Safe Online” checklist with actionable prevention tips which minimalizes a person’s chances to fall prey to online fraudulent tactics. These tips, while useful for every person, is especially useful for college or university students in India.

While researching cybercrime, I was most surprised by how easily people fall victim to scams through simple tricks like fake links or urgent payment requests. Many attacks don’t require advanced hacking skills—they rely on manipulating human behaviour. I also learned how quickly financial fraud can happen, especially through UPI apps, and how important it is to act fast by reporting incidents. This made me realize that awareness is the first line of defence.

One habit I will change is being more cautious before approving any online transaction or clicking links, even if they appear trustworthy. I will also make it a point to verify sources and use stronger security measures like two-factor authentication on all important accounts.

Conclusion:

This Digital Literacy project has been a valuable learning experience that strengthened my understanding of essential digital skills required in today's world. Through practical tasks, I learned how to create informative content, build a professional online presence, explore useful platforms, and communicate effectively through emails. I also gained awareness about cybercrime and the importance of staying safe online. The project helped me improve both my technical and communication skills while encouraging responsible digital behaviour. Overall, it has increased my confidence in using digital tools efficiently and prepared me to use technology in a smarter, safer, and more professional manner.

References:

- **Tools/Platforms Cited:**
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